APPROACH:

Make sure that you go through the following steps

STEP 1: Before writing your essay

DECONSTRUCT THE TOPIC

- Highlight or underline the keywords in the topic and consider them carefully.
  NB: Remember to look at the instruction or command word that has been used i.e. Discuss, Analyse, Argue etc.
- Provide synonyms for the key words in the topic so that you understand fully what the topic means.



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STEP 2: Writing your essay

- INTRODUCTION:
  Use the deconstruction of the topic to help you STATE YOUR POSITION in relation to ALL aspects of the topic i.e. Do you agree, disagree or partially agree with the topic?
  In the introduction, you must **show understanding of the topic** by using your own words and you must provide the reader with the **direction** in which your essay is going.



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STEP 2: Writing your essay

PARAGRAPH 1

Begin to address the topic.

- State your first point in relation to the topic. This must be substantiated through examples and quotes from the novel.
- Explain the link between your quote or example and the point you are making.
- Link back to the topic with a focus sentence.
- The following slide maps this out for you:



POINT	EVIDENCE	EXPLAIN	LINK
Make the central argument express the main idea in the topic sentence.	Provide evidence or reasons supporting your point in the form of a quote or an example from the text.	Explain the point and how the evidence provided supports it.	Bridge to the next paragraph. Use transitional phrases and refer to your main idea.

Follow this principle for each paragraph



APPROACH:

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STEP 2: Writing your essay

Use the same procedure for each paragraph.

FOR THE CONCLUSION:

- Re-emphasise your position by summing up aspects of your discussion.
- Link your conclusion back to your introduction.
- BE CLEAR and DO NOT INTRODUCE ANY NEW IDEAS.



TIPS FOR A LITERATURE ESSAY

- Write in an academic, formal style.
- Keep your register formal.
- **Do not** use contractions.
- Although you do not need to show planning for your essay, it is a good idea to do a rough plan before you start.
- **You must write in the PRESENT TENSE.**

- ***Beware of sweeping statements and generalisations** such as 'always', 'everybody', 'never' or 'throughout the novel'.*
- ***"Macbeth" is a play not a novel or a book.***
- ***Spell the names of characters correctly.***
- ***Quote accurately and do not quote out of context.***
- ***Remember to underline the title of the novel/play.***

